

EXECUTE PERIOPERATIVE THEATRE ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICES

UNIT DESCRIPTION

This unit standard specifies the competencies required to execute perioperative theatre administrative services. It involves execution/implementation of perioperative theatre policies and performing administrative duties. It also entails the day to day running of perioperative theatre facility.

It applies to Health industry.

1. Administration

Introduction

Administration is defined as the act of managing duties, responsibilities, or rules. It can also be defined as the act of administering; government, public affairs; the service rendered, or duties assumed, in conducting affairs; the conducting of any office or employment; direction.

Types of administrations

- a) Authoritative Administration: **Authoritative** administration refers to a **management** style where the leader is in complete control. An **authoritative** leader is one who sets the goals, determines the processes and oversees all steps it takes to reach those goals with little or no input from team members
- b) Democratic Administration: Also known as participative **administration** or shared **leadership**, is a type of **administrative** style in which members of the group take a more participative role in the decision-making process
- c) Laissez-faire administration: also known as de- legative leadership, is a type of leadership style in which leaders are hands-off and allow group members to make the decisions.

1.1 Administrative duties and roles

The role of an administrator is vital in any company and varies from organization to organization. However, the necessary skills or responsibilities are all the same in different organizations. One of the most common and significant duties of an administrator is to look after the business operations. For this, an administrator needs to have a good set of skills so that he/she can manage a team of people who can handle any situation within the organization. Excellent communication is one of the most important key ingredients for an administrator

Important skills of an administrator

- A great team player

- A desire to take an initiative
- Ability to withstand pressure cooker situations
- Organization Skills and a systematic approach to work
- Good at juggling tasks and prioritizing
- Attention to minute details

1 Roles of an Administrator

Planning and Organizing

Planning is the most vital task of an administrator. It is a responsibility for him/her to plan long-term objectives that can help the organization to reach its ultimate goal. Moreover, to execute these plans and get success is again a big responsibility. The professionals in the admin **department in any company need to analyze** that how, when, where, and with whom the plan should be made and executed accordingly.

Organizing is again equally important, which lets the administrator coordinate the efforts of a business to reach heights of success.

Directing

So, after planning and organizing are done, the administrator begins direction, which is to be followed by all in the company. Leading the employees within the company to attain the main objective of the organization needs the amalgamation of resources and an effective support system. An interpersonal skill, which is the most commonly found talent among the administrators, is essential as he/she needs to interact and deal with people with different personalities. Moreover, an efficient administrator will use the potential of the workforce to make the plan work as a set. It includes the entrustment of authority, accountability, and control to other administrative teams.

Staffing

Staffing is another important role of an administrator. For this, complete knowledge about the company and to understand what it requires is very necessary. The administrator must interact and coordinate with other departments of the organization, including the human resource department. Not only the HR department but the admin department, too, actively take part in the recruitment and screening process. After the hiring process is done, the admin team should keenly appraise the progress of the new member of the company.

Liaison

An efficient administrator is a liaison between employees and management. The admin team understands the need for the employees as well as the management and hence plans things accordingly to meet their demands. It helps to maintain a balance in the organization and also to keep a positive environment free from conflicts. It is the sole responsibility of an administrator to take care of the expectations and performances of each individual.

The administration department is the backbone of the company. A skilled and efficient administrator is an asset to the organization. He/she is a link between the employees and the management of the company. Without an excellent team of an admin department, an organization cannot run smoothly.

Role of Hospital Administrators

General roles

Canadian management expert [Henry Mintzberg](#) distinguishes ten key managerial roles that managers and executives need to fulfill.

The managerial roles as described by Mintzberg is grouped into three categories, which are equally relevant for hospital administrator also.

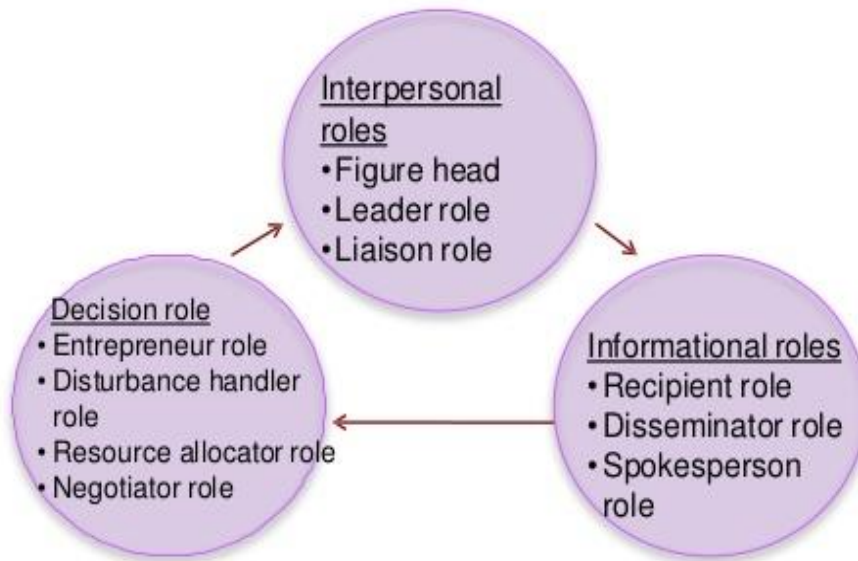


Figure 1

1.2 Policies and Standard Operating Procedures.

Policies and standard operating procedures are the foundations of an organization. Even if they're not written down, policies and procedures define your organization and ensure that things are running smoothly. For best results, however, both policies and procedures should be written down and codified to avoid misunderstandings or inefficiencies. There are lots of

“policy and procedure” software’s out there that helps organizations to put those rules and processes down and share them with employees; in practice.

2 Defining Policies

Policies are principles or beliefs within an organization that set direction, guide and influence decision-making. Policies guide the day-to-day actions and strategies, but allow for flexibility – the big keyword for policies is “guiding”. They establish a framework of management philosophies, aims and objectives. Policy can be driven by business philosophy, competition, marketplace pressure, law or regulation and in many cases all of these.

Organizational policies tend to have topics such as social media use, sick time and paid leave, acceptable work behavior and codes of conduct, employee onboarding and termination, workplace discrimination and proper certifications and licensing among a plethora of other topics, some specific to your business.

3 Defining standard operating Procedures

SOPs have a narrow focus; they describe, step by step, what actions to take in specific instances. Procedures have a beginning and an end and should be strictly followed to achieve the desired outcome. The cyclical nature and uniformity of a procedure are vitally important for training new employees, compliance, and process improvement and auditing.

Examples of procedural topics include emergency procedures in theatre, material ordering, equipment operation or how to inventory supplies and goods

4 Some Key Differences between policies and SOPs

When it comes to creating, updating and implementing your policies and procedures, there are some key differences.

Policies:

- Change infrequently
- State who, what when or why
- Are broad and general

Procedures (SOPs)

- Continuously change and improve
- State what, how, when or who
- Offer a detailed description of activities

5 Why are company or organizational policies important?

Company policies put in writing what you expect from your employees. These may be related to performance, values or behavior. Additionally, company policies can serve as pre-warnings for employees, since they outline the consequences of failing to abide by the rules.

Company policies are important for a variety of other reasons, including:

- Setting expectations
- Keeping management accountable
- Ensuring compliance with the law
- Helping defend against legal claims
- Assisting with fair treatment of employees

6 List of organization policies to consider creating

Here are some of the policies that your company should consider putting in place:

1. Equal opportunity policy

Many countries mandate that you must be an equal opportunity employer by law. For example, in the United States, the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission enforces a wide range of federal laws that prohibit workplace discrimination.

An equal opportunity policy (EOP) prevents companies from discriminating against job applicants or employees if they are a member of a protected class (e.g., race, gender, age, religion, familial status, color). The EOP is essential for any anti-harassment, workplace violence, non-discrimination or diversity policies your company may consider developing.

2. Workplace health and safety

It's important to provide your employees with a safe and healthy work environment, especially since workplace health and safety violations can cause harm to your employees, cost your business money and damage your reputation.

Your business should be proactive and write a health and safety policy that is designed for each workplace. For example, you might specify what employees should do in case of office emergencies or how to handle unsafe materials. The Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) has guidelines on how to create a safe workplace and protect workers from occupational hazards that you can base your policy on.

3. Employee code of conduct policy

A clear and concise code of conduct can help employees understand your expectations in terms of performance and behavior. This policy might include specific rules related to substance abuse, sexual harassment, giving gifts, dress code, confidentiality, and even the use of cell phones or social media during work hours.

4. Attendance, vacation and time-off policies

Having a standard way to request a day off or take vacation leave will help things run more smoothly in the office. The policy should outline how much time off employees receive, when and how they can accrue more time off, who they should contact to request their time off and anything else they may need to know. You can also choose to create a separate attendance policy that outlines what is considered tardy, how far in advance they should request time off and what happens if they don't show up for work.

Here's an example of a company attendance policy you can use to help write your own:

Employees are expected to be on time and regular in attendance. This means being at your workspace and ready to work at your scheduled time each day. You will be given a 10-minute grace period after the start of your shift before you will be considered tardy. Employees who are tardy on more than five occasions will be subject to disciplinary action. Absenteeism and tardiness are burdensome to your co-workers and leaders, and will not be tolerated without just cause.

4. Employee disciplinary action policy

Some of the most important company policies involve discipline and employee conduct. Before you can hold your employees accountable for their actions, it's important to record your expectations in terms of performance and behavior in your employee handbook or individual employee contracts. With complete access to the rules and regulations of the workplace, you can then enforce disciplinary action when appropriate while using the employee handbook as a point of reference.

A simple step-by-step list of what happens regarding disciplinary action can make it easy for employees to know what to expect if they violate a company policy. Describe a specific process you will follow to ensure every employee is treated fairly when it comes to discipline. Have a lawyer review this information before you include it in your employee handbook to make sure all disciplinary action is legal.

6. Employee complaint policies

Grievances are formal complaints your employees can file to document their concerns with an aspect of their workplace. These grievances might be filed as a result of an incident or conflict with a fellow employee. A grievance can be filed for nearly any reason, including physical workplace complaints, financial issues like payroll and social circumstances like harassment or bullying. It's important to outline a formal process for resolving complaints within your company so that employees know how to handle their concerns in a professional way.

It may also be a good idea to develop a non-retaliation policy to protect employees who make good faith complaints against their manager or co-workers.

7 How to develop company policies as an employer

If you want to develop business policies to address important workplace issues, consider following the steps below:

1. Identify the need for the policy

Observe the way your management and employees deal with workplace issues, and identify which areas could use improvement. For instance, if employees consistently violate unwritten rules, you may consider adding a new policy that addresses this and other related issues.

2. Determine the content needed for the policy

Write down key areas that need to be addressed within the policy. For instance, you can include different sections or clauses that prevent you or your employees from finding loopholes. Consider all aspects of the policy, what you would like your employees to do and what you would like them to avoid doing. It's also a good idea to include what form of disciplinary action will be taken if a policy is violated.

3. Communicate the new policy to employees

Current employees need to be notified of new policies when they're released or added to the employee handbook. You may even consider adding a signature line to the new policy to make sure employees know that they must follow the rule from the date they sign it. This prevents conflict later on if an employee states they were never aware of the policy after receiving disciplinary action for violating it.

It's also important to review and discuss company policies with new employees during onboarding so they know what to expect. Consider having them sign a form stating that they were given an employee handbook or a list of your policies, rules and regulations.

4. Update and revise the policy as necessary

You may consider amending or revising your policies as necessary in accordance with laws and regulations or according to your company's objectives and any employee feedback.

Why Are Standard Operating Procedures Important?

The important task of writing policies and procedures rarely gets the respect it deserves. Most people recognize the need for having standard policies, but standard operating procedures often get viewed as a necessary evil. Why is that?

Good procedures and work instructions provide a way to communicate and apply consistent standards and practices within your organization.

GOOD procedures . . .

- save time and mistakes
- reduce training costs
- ensure consistent results
- empower the workforce
- get read and used
- support quality goals

- enable you to delegate work

But, **BAD procedures**, can be as **disastrous** as no procedures at all!

Bad procedures . . .

- cause errors and frustration
- increase training costs
- waste time and money
- detract from quality goals
- don't get read or used

2. Supervisory services

Definition

Supervision is a professional and collaborative activity between a supervisor and a worker in which the supervisor provides guidance and support to the worker to promote competent and ethical delivery of services and supports through the continuing development of the worker's application of accepted professional peer work knowledge, skills, and values.

Benefits of supervision in an organization

- Supervision is a tool that can be used to achieve the agency's mission and objectives
- Supervision improves performance and helps to manage resources
- The supervisor serves as the mediator and liaison between the agency and the worker
- Good supervision can increase morale and improve retention

Functions of a supervisor

a) Administrative

Administrative supervision tasks focus on the effective implementation of the agency's policies and procedures and the management of the peer worker's work performance.

- Quality of work
- Work load
- Liaison to operations - payroll, human resources
- Using program resources, including time, effectively
- Conformance or fidelity to the program model
- Record keeping

b) Educative

Educative supervision tasks focus on the professional development of the worker through training, modeling and structuring learning experiences.

- Provide time and space to reflect on peer practice
- Focus on knowledge, skills and attitudes
- Provide individualized training and support
- Provide venue for supporting the peer worker's professional development

c) Supportive

Supportive supervision tasks focus on the person's morale and job satisfaction.

- Give feedback on work
- Discuss personal reactions to the work
- Validate and provide encouragement
- Promote self-care practices
- Advocate for peer support roles

Supervision formats

a) Individual supervision

Advantages

- Exclusive attention to the worker
- Often experienced as safer by the worker
- More confidential

Disadvantages

- Dependence can develop
- Exposure to only one perspective in supervision
- Lost opportunity to learn from colleagues

b) Group supervision

Advantages

- More efficient than individual supervision
- Supervisees share information and may learn from each other
- Can be a powerful way to reduce isolation and may foster group cohesiveness

Disadvantages

- Working in a group can be experienced as unsafe by some workers
- It may difficult to meet the specific needs of individual participants and there is a risk discussions remain generalized and do not meet anyone's needs in a satisfactory way

c) Co-supervision

Co - supervision is the provision of supervision by more than one supervisor • This model may be used when the organization does not have supervisors who are peer support workers • Peer workers may benefit from a second supervisor if their primary supervisor doesn't have the expertise to help them develop in their peer practice • Often, one supervisor provides more administrative supervision and the other provides more education. Ideally, both provide support.

Advantages

- Workers benefit from the guidance of more than one person
- Workers can develop their competencies with a skills peer support worker

Disadvantages

- Some agencies don't have the resources to offer co – supervision
- There may be challenges in communication or disagreements between the co-supervisors
- Co - supervisors may not share the same expectations

Many organizations offer multiple formats of supervision to address different professional development needs and different workers get different learning needs addressed by different formats.

2.1 Human resource management :

Human resource management is the process of employing **people**, training them, compensating them, developing policies relating to the workplace, and developing strategies to retain employees

Roles of HRM

8 Staffing

You need people to perform tasks and get work done in the organization. Even with the most sophisticated machines, humans are still needed. Because of this, one of the major tasks in HRM is staffing. Staffing involves the entire hiring process from posting a job to negotiating a salary package. Within the staffing function, there are four main steps:

1. **Development of a staffing plan.** This plan allows HRM to see how many people they should hire based on revenue expectations.
2. **Development of policies to encourage multiculturalism at work.** Multiculturalism in the workplace is becoming more and more important, as we have many more people from a variety of backgrounds in the workforce.

3. **Recruitment.** This involves finding people to fill the open positions.
4. **Selection.** In this stage, people will be interviewed and selected, and a proper compensation package will be negotiated. This step is followed by training, retention, and motivation.

9 **Development of Workplace Policies**

Every organization has policies to ensure fairness and continuity within the organization. One of the jobs of HRM is to develop the verbiage surrounding these policies. In the development of policies, HRM, management, and executives are involved in the process. For example, the HRM professional will likely recognize the need for a policy or a change of policy, seek opinions on the policy, write the policy, and then communicate that policy to employees. It is key to note here that HR departments do not and cannot work alone. Everything they do needs to involve all other departments in the organization. Some examples of workplace policies might be the following:

- Discipline process policy
- Vacation time policy
- Dress code
- Ethics policy
- Internet usage policy

10 **Compensation and Benefits Administration**

HRM professionals need to determine that compensation is fair, meets industry standards, and is high enough to entice people to work for the organization. Compensation includes anything the employee receives for his or her work. In addition, HRM professionals need to make sure the pay is comparable to what other people performing similar jobs are being paid. This involves setting up pay systems that take into consideration the number of years with the organization, years of experience, education, and similar aspects. Examples of employee compensation include the following:

- Pay
- Health benefits
- retirement plans or packages

- Stock purchase plans
- Vacation time
- Sick leave
- Bonuses
- Tuition reimbursement

11 Retention

Retention involves keeping and motivating employees to stay with the organization.

Compensation is a major factor in employee retention, but there are other factors as well.

Ninety percent of employees leave a company for the following reasons:

1. Issues around the job they are performing
2. Challenges with their manager
3. Poor fit with organizational culture
4. Poor workplace environment

Despite this, 90 percent of managers think employees leave as a result of pay (Rivenbark, 2010). As a result, managers often try to change their compensation packages to keep people from leaving, when compensation isn't the reason they are leaving at all.

12 Training and Development

Once we have spent the time to hire new employees, we want to make sure they not only are trained to do the job but also continue to grow and develop new skills in their job. This results in higher productivity for the organization. Training is also a key component in employee motivation. Employees who feel they are developing their skills tend to be happier in their jobs, which results in increased employee retention. Examples of training programs might include the following:

- Job skills training, such as how to run a particular computer program
- Training on communication
- Team-building activities

- Policy and legal training, such as sexual harassment training and ethics training

13 Dealing with Laws Affecting Employment

Human resource people must be aware of all the laws that affect the workplace. An HRM professional might work with some of these laws:

- Discrimination laws
- Health-care requirements
- Compensation requirements such as the minimum wage
- Worker safety laws
- Labor laws

The legal environment of HRM is always changing, so HRM must always be aware of changes taking place and then communicate those changes to the entire management organization. Rather than presenting a chapter focused on HRM laws, we will address these laws in each relevant chapter.

14 Worker Protection

Safety is a major consideration in all organizations. Oftentimes new laws are created with the goal of setting federal or state standards to ensure worker safety. Unions and union contracts can also impact the requirements for worker safety in a workplace. It is up to the human resource manager to be aware of worker protection requirements and ensure the workplace is meeting both federal and union standards. Worker protection issues might include the following:

- Chemical hazards
- Heating and ventilation requirements
- Use of “no fragrance” zones
- Protection of private employee information

15 Communication

Besides these major roles, good communication skills and excellent management skills are key to successful human resource management as well as general management.

Figure 2: summary of HRM roles



16 Awareness of External Factors

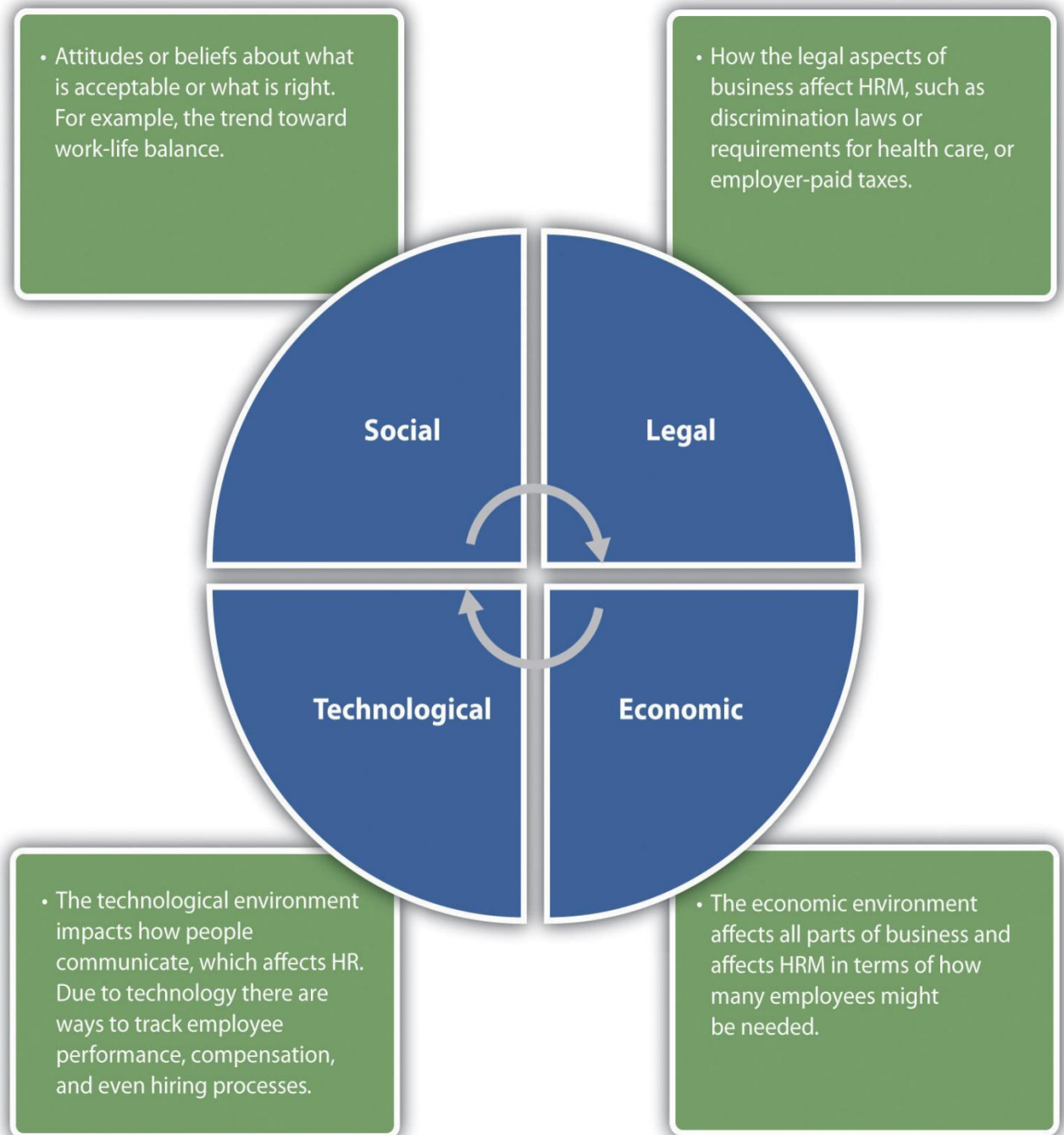
In addition to managing internal factors, the HR manager needs to consider the outside forces at play that may affect the organization. Outside forces, or external factors, are those things the company has no direct control over; however, they may be things that could positively or negatively impact human resources. External factors might include the following:

1. Globalization and offshoring
2. Changes to employment law
3. Health-care costs
4. Employee expectations
5. Diversity of the workforce

6. Changing demographics of the workforce
7. A more highly educated workforce
8. Layoffs and downsizing
9. Technology used, such as HR databases
10. Increased use of social networking to distribute information to employees

For example, the recent trend in flexible work schedules (allowing employees to set their own schedules) and telecommuting (allowing employees to work from home or a remote location for a specified period of time, such as one day per week) are external factors that have affected HR. HRM has to be aware of these outside issues, so they can develop policies that meet not only the needs of the company but also the needs of the individuals. Another example is the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act, signed into law in 2010. Compliance with this bill has huge implications for HR. For example, a company with more than fifty employees must provide health-care coverage or pay a penalty. Currently, it is estimated that 60 percent of employers offer health-care insurance to their employees (Cappelli, 2010). Because health-care insurance will be mandatory, cost concerns as well as using health benefits as a recruitment strategy are big external challenges. Any manager operating without considering outside forces will likely alienate employees, resulting in unmotivated, unhappy workers. Not understanding the external factors can also mean breaking the law, which has a concerning set of implications as well.

Figure 3; Key external factors



An understanding of key external factors is important to the successful HR professional. This allows him or her to be able to make strategic decisions based on changes in the external environment.

2.2 Resource utilization

Resource utilization refers to the metric that indicates whether your whole team, or individual employees, are fully booked. It describes the process of planning a project and

ensuring the available resources in the company are being used to their highest potential. It helps project managers identify which of their employees are being over utilized so they can allocate responsibilities to someone else if needed, and can also assist in identifying the people who are underutilized, so they can assign new projects to them.

Resource Allocation vs. Resource Utilization

While the purpose of both processes may seem similar, there are some key distinctions to be drawn between the two:

- *Resource allocation* refers to a project manager selecting suitable employees for a project, and then managing them as they complete the project, reassigning or altering workloads if necessary.
- *Resource utilization* is the process of strategically measuring how effective resources are. Allocation organizes a project, but it is utilization that makes it successful.

17 Benefits of resource utilization

- Proper utilization of resources is important for maintaining productivity, because it prevents staff from underperforming or being overburdened by workloads and burning out.
- Projects can be managed with better visibility, reducing the risk of oversights
- Maximum utilization of resources gives you a better ROI (Return on investment)
- It ensures that specific resources aren't being over or under-utilized
- It allows property management systems to be agile and reschedule resources as quickly as possible to avoid problems surfacing or becoming worse

Tips for Implementing Resource Utilization

When a company has a robust resource management platform, project managers have access to the tools needed to approach and master effective resource utilization. Some key tips to keep in mind include:

- **Leverage Visibility** – especially for larger companies, several projects may be running at the same time, and while they exist separately they still affect one another down the line. Rather than looking at projects as separate entities, formulate a resource utilization plan that can provide insight into project-specific metrics, as well as an overview of

all resources in the company. This way, you will be able to assess overall work capacity and resource performance on a bigger picture scale, helping identify any company-wide areas of improvement.

- **Beware of Scope Creep** – projects are shape shifting by nature, so some will inevitably demand additional time and resources. It is the responsibility of the project manager to ensure projects don't go over allotted time or budget. A resource utilization strategy can help centralize all active projects, leveraging resources equally amongst them to help keep things within their optimal scope.
- **Always Be Prepared** – as a project manager, you need to be prepared for any and all scenarios. During your planning process, visualize and run through various situations that could arise, and prepare for a change of circumstances as if it were inevitable. This way, if the budget changes, or a resource is lost, your team will be able to adapt more quickly.

2.3 Service delivery

Service delivery can be defined as any contact with the public administration during which customers – citizens, residents or enterprises – seek or provide data, handle their affairs or fulfil their duties. These **services** should be **delivered** in an effective, predictable, reliable and customer-friendly manner.

The **four** key elements for successful service delivery system are

1. **Service Culture** is built on elements of leadership principles, norms, work habits and vision, mission and values. Culture is the set of overriding principles according to which management controls, maintains and develops the social process that manifests itself as delivery of service and gives value to customers. Once a superior service delivery system and a realistic service

concept have been established, there is no other component as fundamental to the long-term success of a service organization as its culture.

2. **Employee Engagement** includes employee attitude activities, purpose driven leadership and HR processes. Even the best designed processes and systems will only be effective if carried out by people with higher engagement. Engagement is the moderator between the design and the execution of the service excellence model.
3. **Service Quality** includes strategies, processes and performance management systems. The strategy and process design is fundamental to the design of the overall service management model. Helping the client fulfil their mission and supporting them in the pursuit of their organizational purpose, must be the foundation of any service provider partnership.
4. **Customer Experience** includes elements of customer intelligence, account management and continuous improvements. Perception is king and constantly evaluating how both customer and end-user perceive service delivery is important for continuous collaboration. Successful service delivery works on the basis that the customer is a part of the creation and delivery of the service and then designs processes built on that philosophy – this is called co-creation

2.4 Motivation of employees

Definition: Employee motivation is defined as the enthusiasm, energy level, commitment and the amount of creativity that an employee brings to the organization on a daily basis.

Employee motivation is all about how engaged an employee feels in tandem to the organization's goals and how empowered he/she feels. Motivation is of two types:

- Intrinsic motivation
- Extrinsic motivation

Motivated employees are an asset to an organization, they are directly proportional to an organization's success. Motivation is intangible, difficult to measure and extremely difficult to control, but very easy to facilitate if done right. It's all about intention, intensity, and perseverance

Intrinsic motivation

Intrinsic motivation means that an individual is motivated from within. He/she has the desire to perform well at the workplace because the results are in accordance with his/her belief system.

An individual's deep-rooted beliefs are usually the strongest motivational factors. Such individuals show common qualities like acceptance, curiosity, honor, and desire to achieve success.

Extrinsic motivation

Extrinsic motivation means an individual's motivation is stimulated by external factors- rewards and recognition. Some people may never be motivated internally and only external motivation would work with them to get the tasks done.

Ways of motivating employees

1. **Employee motivation surveys:** Use an online survey software or platform to conduct employee motivation surveys. Let them give candid and genuine feedback about their experience, ideas, and suggestions. This will help you identify areas that need your attention.
2. **Employee satisfaction surveys:** Employee satisfaction depends on a ton of factors such as work environment, infrastructure, roles and responsibilities, etc. Conducting employee satisfaction surveys will help Managers understand dissatisfaction factors and act on them. Frequent surveys will help addressing dissatisfaction issues faster.
3. **Job well done- recognize it!** Recognition plays a huge role in increasing the motivation levels of the employees. It helps create a healthy bond between the employer and employees. It not only fulfills our basic need of esteem but also facilitates belonging.
4. **Focus on intrinsic rewards:** It is true some people need rewards to get tasks done, but extrinsic rewards fade very quickly. Focus on motivating your employees from within. Some may even say, "yeah this is all good but we got to eat and pay rent"... well, that's true, for that you compensate your employees well, but make sure you create values for your organization that are long-lasting.

5. **Autonomy not bureaucracy:** Micromanagement is the worst thing you can do as a manager. It is not only time consuming, but also really unwanted. If you have hired people with certain skillset let them do their job, be a facilitator, not a dictator. Human beings value autonomy, give them the freedom to get things done in ways acceptable and see the changes.
6. **Create an amazing work environment:** According to a study conducted by Ohio State University, your work environment seriously impacts your mood. So it does make sense to invest in the work environment where people actually spend 60 hours a week. Creating a good atmosphere will motivate your staff. Just go ahead and do it.
7. **Be a visionary:** Lead with vision. Employees need to know their efforts are driving something important. They need to know their destination and more importantly the path that will take them there. If as a leader you lack the vision for your own organization, how do you expect them to own up to your vision? Make a visual reminder of your organization's road map, encourage your employees to add to that. You will be surprised how innovative they can get.
8. **Solicit ideas and suggestions, act on them:** Now that you have conducted surveys, you have received feedback from your employees. Ensure that the ideas, suggestions, grievances that they have put forth will be looked into and addressed in a timely fashion.
9. **Career-pathing:** Having a career growth plan with clearly mentioned roles and responsibilities is crucial to employees. It helps them focus, and direct their efforts to an achievable goal. Make sure that you sit down with every employee and come up with a career plan that is transparent and communicated clearly.
10. **Provide flexibility:** Not all employees are alike. Some prefer coming to work daily, others not much. For some, commuting to work might be long and challenging. Allow some flexibility within reason and your employees will be happy and motivated

Importance of employee motivation

According to psychologists, self-realization is a very human thing. It is our basic nature to nurture something and see it flourish, it is applicable to most things we do in our day-to-day life. This is true for both social and societal spaces.

Motivation plays a very important factor in a human's life. Whether it is about improving ourselves or our organization's performance. Motivated employees don't need to be told how to get things done, they take initiatives, are eager to take up additional responsibilities, are innovative and go-getters.

Motivated employees ensure:

- There is a positive atmosphere within the organization
- Co-workers are happy and feel safe at work
- Make sure clients are happy
- They always achieve better results than their counterparts

Motivation, therefore, plays a very important factor and ensures employees remain active and contribute their best towards their organization. Furthermore, a high level of motivation leads to a lower level of employee turnover

Herzberg's motivation theory

Herzberg's motivation theory or two-factor theory says there are two factors to which an organization can adjust to influence the levels of motivation at the workplace.

The two factors identified by Herzberg are:

1. Motivating factors: The presence of motivating factors encourages employees to work harder. They are the factors found in the workplace.
2. Hygiene factors: Hygiene factor if not present will discourage employees from doing their best at work. Hygiene factors are the surrounding factors that facilitate employee's behavior. Here are some of the examples of motivators and hygiene factor

Motivators	Hygiene Factors
Recognition	Security
Growth	Company policies
Achievements	Salary
The work itself	Work conditions
Responsibility	Manager/supervisor

There are 4 statistics that are involved here:

1. High hygiene & high motivation

This is an ideal situation any manager or supervisor would want to achieve. Here all the employees are happily motivated and have very few grievances.

2. High hygiene & low motivation

In this situation, employees have very few grievances but are also not highly motivated. A very good example of this situation is employees are paid well but the work is not very interesting. Employees simply collect their pay cheques and leave.

3. Low hygiene and high motivation

This is a tricky one, here employees are highly motivated but also have numerous grievances. A typical example of a situation like this is when the work is extremely interesting but the employees are not paid as per the market standard.

4. Low hygiene & low motivation

No points for guessing, it is obviously a pretty bad situation. Here neither the employees are motivated nor are the hygiene factors in place.

How to apply Herzberg's motivation theory in practice

1. First and foremost rectify and change bureaucratic company policies. Make sure your Human Resources is in line with what other organizations are offering and they know what the leadership's expectations are. Keeping both in mind draft policies that is a win-win with everyone.
2. Ensure your managers are also mentors and not just bosses. Each employee should be respected and supported.
3. Organizational culture plays a very crucial role here. No cliches here.
4. Make sure the compensation, perks, and bonuses are as per the market standards. If you don't compensate your employees well, why would they show interest in taking any initiatives?

5. To increase job satisfaction make sure the jobs are constructed well and employees find their jobs meaningful.

6. Delegate your employees' responsibilities, make them feel valued. Respect their individuality, listen to their feedback seriously and take action wherever necessary.

3. Implementation of policies at work place

Policy implementation is generally defined as a series of activities undertaken by government or organizations to achieve the goals and objectives articulated in **policy** statements

Policy implementation process

To implement effective policies and procedures at your workplace, follow these steps to get the best results.

18 Step 1: Consultation

When developing your policies and procedures, you must consult with all relevant stakeholders, including health and safety representatives, contractors (particularly those who work with you regularly), and of course your employees.

Consultation should ensure that every person in your workplace understands the importance of company policies and procedures and why they need to be implemented effectively.

It will also ensure that the policies and procedures are realistic and actionable on a daily basis.

Tip: *Consultation helps to achieve more effective policies and procedures, and is a greater motivation for employees to follow them.*

19 Step 2: Tailor the policy to your business

The policies and procedures you adopt need to be tailored to the needs of your business, not just lifted straight from a generic manual.

If you use policies and procedures from another source, it is essential that you adapt them to your company and your workplace operations.

20 Step 3: Define obligations clearly – be specific!

All policies should be short and succinct.

All procedural steps should be set out in clear and plain English.

This will create an ‘auditable standard’, meaning that you create a standard that can be used to measure whether your workplace health and safety obligations are being met or not.

The obligations outlined in an auditable standard should be defined in enough detail that persons in your workplace understand exactly what is expected of them.

Specifically state what actions should be taken. For example, don’t say “*dispose of chemicals safely*“, but state how this should be done at the site, e.g. “*chemicals must be disposed of in the designated approved dangerous goods waste drum*“.

21 Step 4: Make the policy realistic

Make sure your business has the time, resources and personnel to implement the policy.

There is no point in adopting a policy which aspires to the best practice possible if your business cannot realistically adopt the procedures set out.

This is the development stage of the policy and procedure done. Once you have completed these steps, you will have the policies and procedures your company needs to maintain a healthy and safe workplace.

But the next stage is just as important as the development stage, the implementation stage...

Don’t get too excited that you have developed the policies and procedures because without implementing them correctly, they won’t be of any use to you.

22 Step 5: Publicize the policies and procedures

Put your policies and procedures in writing and make them available to your entire workforce.

If possible, keep all your policies and procedures in a single manual, and make copies readily available to all employees.

Tip: *Safety documents should also be published on the company's intranet if you have one.*

23 Step 6: Train all employees in policies and procedures

You have an obligation to provide adequate information, instruction, supervision and training to your employees.

Ensure that new employees and contractors are trained and familiar with company policies and procedures, and that existing staff receive appropriate training, e.g. annual refresher courses.

Policies and procedures should also be reiterated and discussed with staff regularly at team meetings to ensure that employees remain aware of the importance & advantages of the policies and procedures.

Tip: *It is a good idea to have all employees and contractors sign off after they have read, understood and agree to comply with your workplace policies. You should also keep records of training and induction. Make sure that you record attendees and details of training content in case an employee fails to sign a training record.*

24 Step 7: Be consistent in your policy implementation

Supervision of your workplace to ensure that the policies and procedures are being properly implemented by all employees is essential.

Follow-up to ensure that any failure to follow the policy or procedure is addressed.

Specify that full compliance with the stated requirements is needed to ensure a safe workplace.

After this, any deliberate breaches of policies or procedures must be treated seriously, and dealt with immediately and consistently.

All supervisors and managers must 'lead by example' in implementing policies and procedures.

If managers condone practices which do not fall within the policy, it could be argued that disciplinary action against an employee who fails to follow the policy is unfair. The consequence of any deliberate breach should be appropriate to the severity of the breach, whether it be:

- counselling;
- disciplinary action (e.g. a warning); or
- In serious circumstances, dismissal.

25 Step 8: Review all policies and procedures regularly

Policies and procedures must be reviewed periodically.

When any changes occur, ensure your policies and procedures remain relevant and effective. For example, a change may occur when a business purchases a new piece of machinery, starts using a new chemical or adopts a new production method. Any such changes mean that relevant procedures should be reviewed.

Tip: *The review cycle will depend on the circumstances and document type, but it is a good idea to review policies at least every 2 years*

Implement a document management system that:

- triggers reviews;
- notes the dates of change; and
- Involves interactive revision.

All employees and contractors need to be made aware of the changes to policy and procedure when they occur.

26 Step 9: Enforce the workplace policies and procedures

Once your policies and procedures have been implemented, they need to be enforced. Make sure that you approach this consistently as this is an important factor in being able to discipline a worker for a breach of policy.

Problems of Policy Implementation

27 *Equality, Equity and Policy: Problems of Policy Implementation*

Theoretical framework

Implementation is the process of turning policy into practice. However, it is common to observe a 'gap' between what was planned and what actually occurs as a result of policy implementation. There are three major theoretical models of policy implementation (Buse et al, 2005).

Top-down approach: This approach sees policy formation and policy execution as distinct activities. Policies are set at higher levels in a political process and are then communicated to subordinate levels which are charged with the technical, managerial, and administrative tasks of putting policy into practice. Political scientists have theorized that the top-down approach requires that certain conditions be in place for policy implementation to be effective including:

- Clear and logically consistent objectives
- Adequate causal theory (to how particular actions would lead to desired outcomes)
- An implementation process designed to enhance compliance by implementers (using incentives and sanctions)
- Committed, skillful implementing officials
- Support from interest groups and legislature
- No changes in socio-economic conditions that undermine political support or the causal theory underlying the policy
- Adequate time and sufficient resources available
- Good coordination and communication

Problems associated with the top down approach:

- It is very unlikely that all pre-conditions would be present at the same time
- Only adopts perspective of those in higher levels of government and neglects the role of other actors
- Risks over-estimating the impact of government action (neglects other factors)
- Difficult to apply where no single, dominant policy or agency is involved
- Policies change as they are being implemented

Bottom-up approach: This approach recognizes that individuals at subordinate levels are likely to play an active part in implementation and may have some discretion to reshape objectives of the policy and change the way it is implemented. The bottom-up approach sees policy implementation as an interactive process involving policy makers, implementers from various levels of government, and '*street level bureaucrats*' such as frontline staff. Policy may change during implementation.

Problems of the bottom-up approach:

- Evaluating the effects of a policy becomes difficult
- Difficult to separate the influence of individuals and different levels of government on policy decisions and consequences. (Important for bureaucratic accountability)

Principal-agent theory: In each situation there will be a relationship between principals (those who define policy) and agents (those who implement policy), which may include contracts or agreements that enable the principal to specify what is provided and check that this has been accomplished. The amount of discretion given to the agents and the complexity of the principal-agent relationship are affected by:

- The nature of the policy problem- including scale of change required, size of affected group, simple vs. complex intervention, ill-defined vs. clear policy, many cause vs. single cause, degree of political sensitivity, length of time before changes become apparent.
- The context or circumstances surrounding the problem- political and economic climate, technological change
- The organization of the machinery required to implement the policy- number of formal and informal agencies, amount of skills and resources required.

In practice

Interpretation of policy directives requires the translation of knowledge on interventions into the particular local context. Factors to take into account when interpreting health policy include (Jenkin *et al* 2013):

- Local resources, including human resources and infrastructure
- Specific characteristics of the population
- Baseline incidence of the health problem
- The latency period before an effect of the intervention will be observed
- Local variations in the likely effectiveness of particular interventions

Gunn (1978 in Hunter 2003) has identified ten common barriers to effective health policy implementation:

- The circumstances external to the implementing agency impose crippling constraints
- Lack of adequate time and sufficient resources
- The required combination of resources is not available
- The policy to be implemented is not based on a valid theory of cause and effect
- The relationship between cause and effect is indirect and there are multiple intervening links
- Dependency relationships are multiple
- There is a poor understanding of, and disagreement on, objectives
- Tasks are not fully specified in correct sequence
- There is imperfect communication and coordination

3. Liaison services

Liaison services include facilitating communications, establishing partnership contract plans and procedures, managing conflicts, providing immediate resolution for concerns, and evaluating collaboration parameters

A liaison officer is an employee who builds and maintains mutually beneficial relationships, facilitates communications and coordinates activities among two or more

people, agencies or organizations. Often a member of the public relations team, liaison officers are company representatives that streamline operations and handle public communications, coordination efforts, incident response and conflict resolution. They act as technical or subject matter experts for the person, agency or organization they represent.

Roles and responsibilities of a liaison officer

A liaison officer works in fast-paced, high-pressure environments and must be willing to take initiative to proactively solve conflicts and address issues. Liaison officer duties include the following:

- acting as contact points for all agency or organizational personnel;
- keeping lists of the agencies or personnel representing the person, agency or organization;
- facilitating meetings and cooperation among people, agencies and organizations;
- identifying problems in communications among these groups;
- collaborating and communicating with necessary constituents and the public; and
- Conducting post-mortems when an incident is wrapped up.

Requirements for a successful liaison services in an organization

1. Champions: The liaison person must believe that the program is worthwhile

The ideal liaison person is:

- a champion: someone who genuinely believes in the program and advocates for it energetically
- an opinion leader: someone with informal organizational influence
- A boundary spanner: someone well-connected in their workplace who can also communicate effectively with the program providers.

We found that where liaison people held an indifferent or negative view of the program they unintentionally undermined it, while those who were enthusiastic amplified others' enthusiasm. So genuine support for the program is more important than influence or connections.

2. Credibility: The liaison person should be an authentic advocate for the program

Colleagues judged the suitability and effectiveness of their liaison person in terms of how well they modelled and espoused research-informed policymaking. This suggests that for a liaison person to be a credible champion they must be perceived as someone who believes in what they are saying and knows what they are talking about.

3. Connections: The liaison person should have sound cross-organizational knowledge and networks

The program was more creatively tailored and integrated, and better attuned to each organization's professional development expectations, when their liaison person consulted with colleagues and advised the program providers. Liaison people's ability to act as intermediaries required them to have (or be able to rapidly acquire) knowledge about multiple aspects of their organization. Broad connections across the organization ensured that their championing efforts were not restricted to local contexts, but it was their nuanced understanding of diverse organizational needs and perspectives that enabled them to represent and respond to their colleagues so effectively.

4. Social skills: The liaison person should have good interpersonal and communication skills

The quality of connections was as important as the quantity for supporting organizational understanding and engagement. Our most effective liaison people were persuasive, approachable and well-liked: people are more inclined to do things for people they like. Adaptability and project management skills were also vital.

5. Support: Organizational leaders need to visibly back the liaison person as well as the program

Strong, visible support from managers assured liaison people that their efforts – even when they verged on 'nagging' – were seen as reasonable and warranted. Colleagues confirmed that evident support from above increased the liaison person's authority and demonstrated they were acting on behalf of management.

6. Incentives: If possible, the liaison person role should be incentivized within the organization

Liaison people were more enthusiastic about the implementation when they benefited professionally from the role. This included building tasks into performance indicators and

increased organizational status or exposure. But incentives should not pressure liaison people to coerce participation.

7. Clear expectations: Organizations need clear upfront guidance about the liaison person role

The liaison people in our study had strikingly different perceptions of their role (eg. as event organizers, project managers, collaborators, connectors, translators and integrators). Liaison people and their managers needed to see the role as skilled facilitation rather than merely administration, and to understand its key attributes, responsibilities, support needs and likely time commitments. The program providers must describe these clearly and realistically.

8. Flexibility: The liaison role can be interpreted by each organization

Providing it does not compromise implementation fidelity, it may help to take a flexible approach to the liaison role, so that core objectives and tasks are specified but the strategies for achieving them are developed locally. For example, organizations might prefer to divide the role between two members of staff: one taking responsibility for administration and another for creative and strategic decisions.

9. Collaboration: The program providers should work with the liaison person in planning and problem-solving

Where liaison people shared insider knowledge, harnessed local communication channels and made suggestions for increasing the benefits of the program, activities were assessed by the program providers and participants as more attractive and useful. This suggests that working with liaison people as program development partners, rather than as conduits, could increase our ability to develop fit-for-purpose programs that respond sensitively to local conditions.

4. Monitoring and evaluation of services

Monitoring is a continuing function that uses systematic collection of data on specific indicators to provide the management and the main stakeholders of an ongoing intervention with indications of the extent of achievement of objectives and progress in the use of allocated funds.

Indicators

An indicator is a quantitative or qualitative variable that allows changes produced by an intervention relative to what was planned to be measured. It provides a reasonably simple and

reliable basis for assessing achievement, change or performance. An indicator is preferably numerical and can be measured over time to show changes. Indicators, which are determined during the planning phase of a project, usually have the following components:

- What is to be measured? (What is going to change? E.g., higher number of patients operated on a certain condition)
- Unit of measurement to be used (to describe the change, e.g., percentage)
- Pre-programme status (sometimes called the “baseline”, e.g., 40 per cent in 2007)
- Size, magnitude or dimension of intended change (e.g., 75 per cent in 2008)
- Quality or standard of the change to be achieved (e.g., improvement such that patients hospital stay was lowered)
- Target populations(s) (e.g., girls vulnerable to teenage pregnancies from villages)
- Time frame (e.g., January 2008 to January 2009)

Evaluation

Evaluation is the systematic and objective assessment of ongoing and/or completed projects, programmes or policies, in respect of their:

- Design
- Implementation
- Results

The criteria applied in the evaluation are:

- Objectives
- Efficiency
- Effectiveness
- Impact
- Sustainability

Evaluation emphasizes the assessment of outcomes and impact rather than the delivery of outputs.

Differences between monitoring and evaluation

Table 1

	Monitoring	Evaluation
Timing	Monitoring is a continuing function that takes place throughout the implementation of a project/programme.	Evaluation assesses the entire project cycle.
Depth and purpose	Monitoring is a regular part of project or programme management. It focuses on the implementation of the project, comparing what is delivered with what was planned	Evaluation reviews the achievements of the project/ programme and considers whether the plan was the best one to achieve the outcomes Evaluation measures achievements, as well as positive/ negative and intended/ unintended effects. Evaluation looks for lessons to be learned from both success and lack of success, and also looks for best practices which can be applied elsewhere.
Who conducts it	Monitoring is usually done by people directly involved in implementing the project/ programme.	Evaluation is best conducted by an independent outsider who can be impartial in consulting project/ programme staff.
Relationship between monitoring and evaluation Data collected and insights gained in the course of monitoring between are then fed into and used by the evaluation process.		

Importance of monitoring and evaluation in an organization

❖ Greater transparency and accountability

One of the greatest benefits of M&E is helping organizations to track, analyses and report on relevant information and data throughout the life cycle of a project. This allows the project team to provide robust evidence for all their actions and decisions to stakeholders, donors and community members from day one. On the other hand, stakeholders and donors acquire the information and understanding they need to collaborate, communicate, provide inputs and make informed decisions about strategy improvements and project operations. Additionally, M&E helps donors to weigh the efficacy of their funds in a project, which influences their current and future funding plans.

❖ Improved project performance

A well planned M&E helps the project team to get a better understanding of the target population's needs. This helps to define the scope of the project and design objectives that are relevant, measurable and achievable. A well-defined M&E plan also clarifies the process and interventions that will lead to the project's outputs and deliverable. Moreover, M&E helps the team to plan an end-to-end indicator management system, identify effective tools and methodologies to measure, analyses and demonstrate every intervention and its impact on expected outcomes. This enables organizations to see their progress and identify gaps as they arise and make timely amendments to achieve the desired results.

❖ Effective resource allocation

All project operations are interwoven around project budgets. The amount of available cash dictates the duration and magnitude of interventions, choices of resources, number of employees etc. M&E is an effective tool for enhancing the efficiency and effectiveness of finances in project implementation. M&E facilitates with the estimation of the value, worth and impact of project components; and enables the team to verify what works and what doesn't and where more money should be invested or where budget should be cut. M&E allows the team to make appropriate changes to the financial plan on a regular basis to avoid unfavorable contingencies.

❖ **Promotes learning & data-driven decision making**

M&E data provides quantifiable results to help the involved parties to learn from project successes and challenges and be more adaptive. Involved parties are better prepared to respond to the ever-evolving project situations, determine what worked and what did not and why it did not work and how it could be improved and make revisions based on data evidence, rather than assumptions. The team is able to establish links between the past, present and future actions to improve project implementation and to identify what could be replicated and scaled up for sustainability of the current project and for future endeavors.

❖ **Systematic management of organization**

M&E also functions as a performance management tool as it facilitates organizations to gather, disseminate and utilize information and data to improve their internal operations and add value to their organization. Organizations can thus focus on their objectives such as enhancing performance, encouraging innovation, sharing and integrating lessons learned for continuous improvement etc. M&E also streamlines organizational procedures to achieve constructive coordination among different stakeholders and organizational units.

5. Reports

A **report** is a document that presents information in an organized format for a specific audience and purpose. Although summaries of **reports** may be delivered orally, complete **reports** are almost always in the form of written documents.

Types of reports in an organization

Routine or Special:

A Routine Report is prepared and presented as a routine work and at a regular period of time. For example, the annual report of an association or a company which has to be prepared by the secretary or by the Board of Directors at the end of every financial year and copies have to be distributed among the members.

A routine report contains some facts or information either in detail or in a summarized form. It may also be of critical type containing some remark or opinion. For example, the auditor's report on the final accounts of a company. Departmental managers or branch managers have to regularly submit routine reports to the higher authorities.

A Special Report is prepared and presented not as a matter of routine. This is prepared on the basis of some enquiry or investigation either by a single individual or by a body or a committee or a subcommittee or a commission specially formed or entrusted with the duty

General or Confidential:

A General Report is that which is for distribution among many, like the members of an organization- Such reports may be printed in large numbers or even published in newspapers for the public information. The Government publishes reports of different committees or commissions and places them on sale to the public.

A Confidential Report is meant for some superior person or persons and is not for general information. Sometimes the report may be so confidential that the secretary or any other person preparing it. Writes it by hand or types it out him-self.

Formal or Informal:

A Formal Report is that which is prepared according to some prescribed form and at a prescribed time and is presented according to a conventional procedure. For example, the annual report of a company or any association, a report of a branch to its head office, etc.

28 Functions or importance of a report in an organization

- **Provides Information:** The very purpose of preparing a report is **providing information to various levels of management**. The term management includes Foreman, Supervisor, Chairman, Department Manager, General Manager and Special Officer. These people are getting information like trend of the business, cash flow and fund flow etc.
- **Helps in Selection:** Out of the many information available, only relevant information is included in the report. A report **brings many alternatives** out of which a management has to choose one profitable alternative.
- **Role in Control System:** A **target is fixed well in advance** in an organization. The management has to see whether the employees are working according to the targets and standards. The reports are prepared in such a way as to measure the actual performance with the budgeted targets. If there is any unfavorable variances, the reasons are find out and remedial or corrective actions are taken by the management.

In this way, a report is **used as a control tool**. A management can control with the help of this tool.

- **Helpful in Profitable Operations:** A report **highlights the direction of moving the business** and the level of operation. On the basis of this type of report, a management can give clear cut instructions as how to increase the profitability to its employees.
- **Follow the Principle of Management by Exception:** A management has only a minimum time to exercise control. Hence, the activities, which are not carried out according to planning and budget, are highlighted before the management. This is the way of following the principle of management by exception.
- **Helpful in Achieving Overall Objectives:** Report **motivates the executives and employees** to take necessary steps towards increasing the earnings of the organization significantly. In this way, the management is achieving the **maximum profit with the help of reporting system**.

6. Environment protection regulations

Environmental protection is the practice of **protecting** the natural **environment** by individuals, organizations and governments. Its objectives are to conserve natural resources and the existing natural **environment** and, where possible, to repair damage and reverse trends

Waste disposal and management

Waste management or Waste disposal is all the activities and actions required to manage waste from its inception to its final disposal. This includes amongst other things, collection, transport, treatment and *disposal of waste* together with monitoring and regulation. It also encompasses the legal and regulatory framework that relates to waste management encompassing guidance on recycling etc.

29 The Benefits of Waste Management

There are multiple benefits to treating and managing waste. In this section, we will take a closer look at them.

Better Environment

Probably the biggest advantage of managing waste is that it eventually leads to a better and fresher environment.

Waste disposal units also contribute to the well-being of people by helping them become disease-free. The best part: all of this happens while the unnecessary is duly disposed of in a proper and sanitary manner. Multiple waste disposal units should be placed in tier-1 and tier-2 cities in a bid to prep up the process of waste disposal. This will also help implement remarkable safety measures in the long run.

Reduces Pollution

When waste is managed the right way, it doesn't merely eliminate the subsequent waste but also reduces the impact and the intensity of harmful greenhouse gases like carbon-di-oxide, carbon mono-oxide, and methane that are often exuded from accumulated wastes in landfills.

Managing waste reduces our reliance on landfills while also significantly cutting down the many factors that adversely impact our environment.

Conserves Energy

Recycling is one of the biggest aspects of waste management, and over time, it helps conserve energy. One of the biggest instances of this advantage can be traced to the practice of recycling paper.

All of us are probably aware that thousands of trees are cut to produce paper. When a used paper is recycled to create new paper, the need of cutting trees is significantly minimized. This helps conserve energy while also reducing your carbon footprints.

Creates Employment

The recycling industry alone creates hundreds of jobs. As more people adopt this eco-friendly practice, organizations creating and selling recycled products come to the forefront. This helps boost their business while also creating hundreds of jobs.

Helps Make a Difference

By managing waste, you are also making a difference to the society and the world in general. While none of us can completely get rid of garbage, we can always adopt eco-friendly

practices of reducing and reusing waste. This way, you create an example for the people around you, who in turn are now motivated to embrace a sustainable approach.



Source: R. (2020, May 29).

There are eight major categories of waste management, and each of them can be divided into numerous sub-categories.

The categories include source reduction and reuse, animal feeding, recycling, composting, fermentation, landfills, incineration, and land application. Some of these methods like reduction and reuse can be started from the comfort of your homes.

30 Various Methods of Waste Disposal

Although there are many methods of disposing of waste, in this section let's take a look at some of the most commonly used methods that you should know about waste management.

Landfills

Throwing daily waste/garbage in the landfills is the most popularly used method of waste disposal used today. This process of waste disposal focuses attention on burying the waste in the land. Landfills are commonly found in developing countries.

There is a process used that eliminates the odors and dangers of waste before it is placed into the ground.

While it is true this is the most popular form of waste disposal, it is certainly far from the only procedure and one that may also bring with it an assortment of space.

This method is becoming less these days although, thanks to the lack of space available and the strong presence of methane and other landfill gases, both of which can cause numerous contamination problems.

Landfills give rise to air and water pollution which severely affects the environment and can prove fatal to the lives of humans and animals. Many areas are reconsidering the use of landfills.

Incineration/Combustion

Incineration or combustion is a type disposal method in which municipal solid wastes are burned at high temperatures. The process eventually converts them into residues and gaseous products.

The biggest advantage of this type of method is that it can reduce the volume of solid waste to 20 to 30 percent of the original volume. Additionally, it also decreases the space they take up while also reducing the stress on landfills. Incinerators are primarily used in thermal treatment where solid waste materials are converted to heat, gas, steam, and ash. Incineration is also widely popular in countries where landfill space is no longer available, such as the US and Japan.

Recovery and Recycling

Resource recovery is the process of taking useful discarded items for a specific next use. These discarded items are then processed to extract or recover materials and resources or convert them to energy in the form of useable heat, electricity or fuel. Recycling is the process of converting waste products into new products to prevent energy usage and consumption of fresh raw materials. Recycling is the third component of Reduce, Reuse and Recycle waste hierarchy.

The idea behind recycling is to reduce energy usage, reduce the volume of landfills, reduce air and water pollution, reduce greenhouse gas emissions, and preserve natural resources for future use.

Plasma gasification

Plasma gasification is another form of waste management. Plasma is primarily an electrically charged or highly ionized gas. Lighting is one type of plasma that produces temperatures that exceed 12,600 °F. With this method of waste disposal, a vessel uses characteristic plasma torches operating at +10,000 °F which is creating a gasification zone till 3,000 °F for the conversion of solid or liquid wastes into a syngas.

During the treatment of solid waste by plasma gasification, the waste's molecular bonds are broken down as a result of the intense heat in the vessels and the elemental components.

Thanks to this process, the destruction of waste and dangerous materials are found. This form of waste disposal provides renewable energy and an assortment of other fantastic benefits.

Composting

Composting is an easy and natural bio-degradation process that takes organic wastes i.e. remains of plants and garden and kitchen waste and turns into nutrient-rich food for your plants.

Composting, normally used for organic farming, occurs by allowing organic materials to sit in one place for months until microbes decompose it.

Note that composting is often deemed to be one of the best methods of waste disposal as it can turn unsafe organic products into safe compost. The process, however, has its downsides. Some people have found it to be slow, while others have observed that it takes a lot of space. But regardless of these issues, many people are still embracing home composting approaches to manage and reduce waste and turns it to

Waste to Energy (Recover Energy)

Waste-to-Energy, also widely recognized by its acronym WtE is the generation of energy in the form of heat or electricity from waste.

Waste to energy (WtE) process involves the conversion of non-recyclable waste items into useable heat, electricity, or fuel through a variety of processes. This type of so energy is a renewable energy source as non-recyclable waste can be used over and over again to create it.

WtE can also help reduce carbon emissions by offsetting the need for energy from fossil sources. Over time, this reduces global warming and makes our environment better.

Special Waste Disposal

There are certain waste types that are considered hazardous and cannot be disposed of without special handling which will prevent contamination from occurring.

Biomedical waste is one example of such a waste disposal method. It is primarily practiced in health care facilities and similar institutions. The special waste disposal system effectively disposes of hazardous biomedical waste.

Avoidance/Waste Minimization

The easier method of waste management is to reduce the creation of waste materials thereby reducing the amount of waste going to landfills.

Waste reduction can be done through recycling old materials like jar, bags, repairing broken items instead of buying a new one, avoiding the use of disposable products like plastic bags, reusing second-hand items, and buying items that use less designing.

31 The Best Methods of Waste Management

Recycling and composting are a couple of the best methods of waste management.

Composting is so far only possible on a small scale, either by private individuals or in areas where waste can be mixed with farming soil or used for landscaping purposes.

Recycling, on the other hand, can be widely used around the world, with plastic, paper, and metal leading the list of the most recyclable items. Most material recycled is reused for its original purpose. In some instances, they may also be sold for generating profits.

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